



Let me ENTERTAIN YOU!

**Stuck in a jam, morning, noon or night?
Whip out your cell phone—Round One, Fight!**

Observe the young lad, engrossed in a ritual. Note how oblivious he is to his surrounding; grimace as he slams his foot on the pavement, lower lip twisted in pain. Pay heed to the arched eyebrow and the piercing gaze that stares hungrily at a pixilated screen. Select fingers fly over an array of keys, buttons are pressed, princesses rescued and worlds are saved. Ah, a change of pace; now more frantic, forceful; utterances emerge from his mouth and lead those around to him to shame...a dismissive toss of the head,

a sideways glance that ends in a devious smile or maybe a resigned sigh.

You have just spotted a new breed: species *mobilus*, sub-species *entertained*.

The sight is most frequent at bus stops, train stations and the many queues that string our life, whilst we wait in a motionless inertia. What better way to kill time than to play games on a cell phone? With many it's almost an obsession. Jacob Joseph, a 23-year old youth from Goa says, "I play *Snake* on any Nokia phone that I can get my hands on." The most

popular games are Nokia's *Snake II*, *F1*, *Pin ball* and *Space Impact*. "I play whenever I am free," says Mufaddal Patanwala, a self-employed 24-year old. A proud owner of the Nokia 8310, Mufaddal would such as the cell phone makers to create games like bike racing. Even Abdulkadir Dahodwala, a 23-year old computer engineer agrees. "I play games while travelling, and would want games that promise speed and are more competitive."

But buying phones only for the games that they offer is not exactly the topmost